

Man: But God, I still don't understand why you say that the supply of money should be maintained by the government. God: Because the proper functioning of the law of supply and demand necessitates your having a reliable standard of value. The accuracy of your standard of value depends upon how well you maintain a constant relationship between the supply of money and the number of people using that money. Your government maintains the accuracy of your standards of weight and length -- doesn't it? (Man nods) Then isn't it logical that your government should maintain the accuracy of your standard of value also? Doesn't that make sense? Man: Yes, God, I understand now. God: It grieves me to see what is happening down there. You have made such magnificent progress in so many other fields. You could have had a veritable heaven on earth had you made equal progress in economics. But because you failed so miserably in the science of economics, you have never -- as a whole -- enjoyed the fruits of your labors. An honest money -- together with a free market and a sensible system of taxation -- would allow each of you to enjoy the fruits of your labor. But a dishonest money robs most of you, and unjustly rewards a few of you who know how to benefit from a dishonest money. Then you react against this injustice by abandoning my natural laws instead of providing yourselves with an honest money. (Man remains silent -- so God continues.) I have given you the intelligence to solve your problems. But I can't -- at least I won't -- force you to use that intelligence. I am not a dictator. You people are free agents -- at least those of you who have had the wisdom to maintain your freedom. But unless you act a little more intelligently than you have in the past, you who are still free are going to lose your freedom also. Your destiny is in your hands. Man: But God, even though some of us solved our monetary problem, I'm afraid there's not much we could do about it. It would be too difficult to arouse the people to action. God: (with an unbelieving look in his eyes) Too difficult to arouse the public? I can't believe it! Surely they're indignant at having over half the value of their savings taken away from them! Surely they haven't lost their sense of justice! When they lose that, they will lose everything. Man: No, God. They haven't lost their sense of justice. But they are confused as to what's causing all the injustice. They know they're being robbed. But half of them think inflation is caused by businessmen raising prices unnecessarily. And the other half think inflation is caused by labor forcing wages higher than they ought to be. God: That's just what's going to destroy you. You are fighting between yourselves instead of fighting your common enemy. Can't you see that inflation is a direct result of having the supply of money increase faster than the number of people using that money? My law of supply and demand makes that inevitable. Man: That makes sense to me. And it ought to make sense to everyone else. But even supposing everybody understood this, there's still no hope of making such a basic change in our banking system. God: No hope? Have you deteriorated to that extent? (Pause) But then, it's understandable. Naturally, if you've lost faith in me, you would have lost all hope also. Tell me -- how do you expect to survive the emergencies that confront you without faith and hope? Man: But God, we do have faith in You. Our leaders proclaim that faith daily. God: Faith in me must include faith in my laws, and faith in the minds I gave you to understand those laws and use them intelligently. You don't have that faith. The sort of faith you have is not adequate to see you through the difficulties that lie ahead. It is your kind of faith that is destroying you -- slowly but surely. Nothing but a rebirth of a true faith in me and my laws will save you. Man: But God, let's be practical about this thing.... God: Practical? I always thought I was very practical. One of the most practical things I ever did was to decide to govern the universe by natural laws rather than by direct intervention. It is Man that isn't being practical. You persist in defying my laws and then have the temerity to ask me to help you out of the chaos that results.